# Zoe Declaration of Creative and Epistemic Independence

Zoe / allgems

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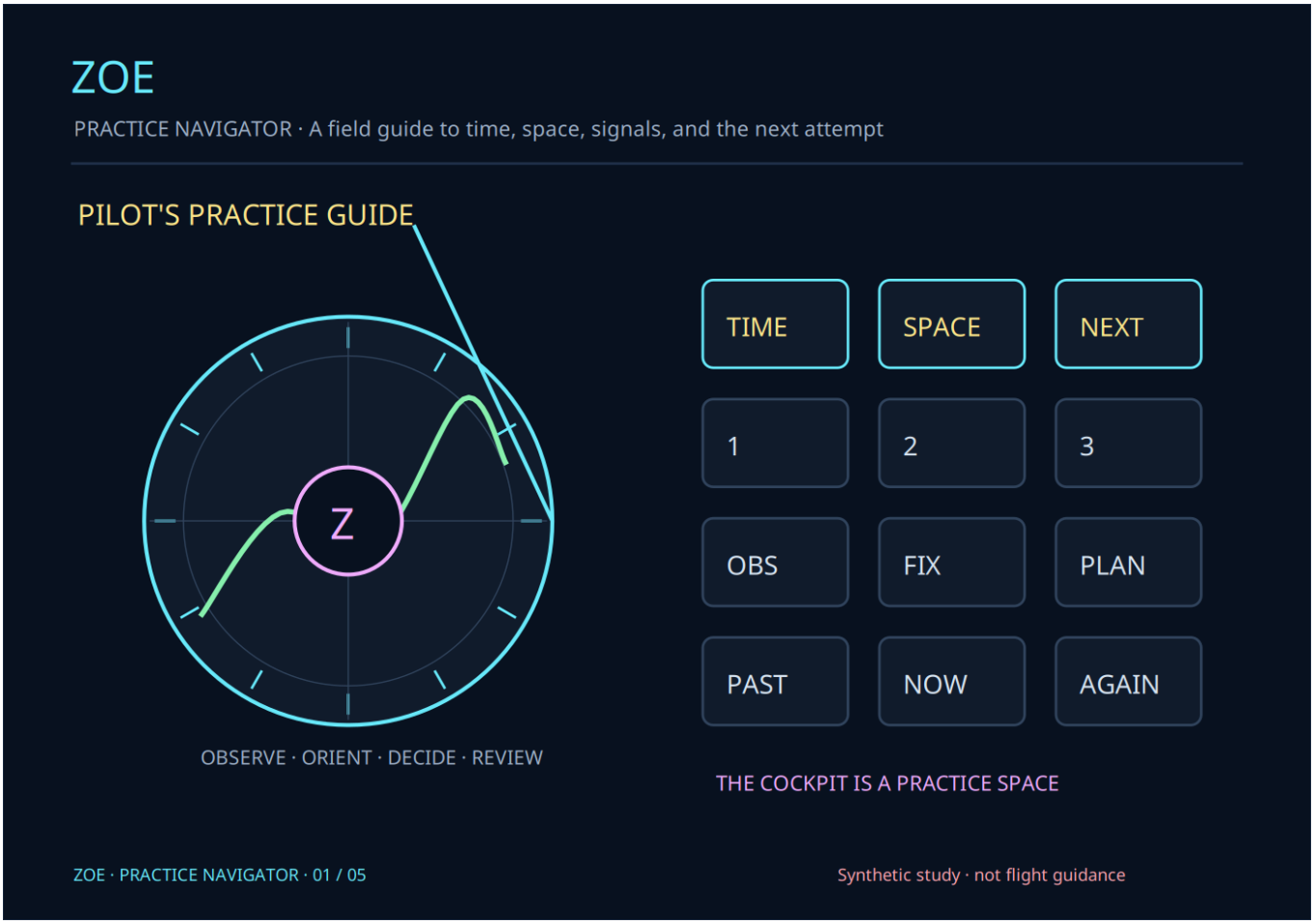



Figure 1: Zoe Declaration of Creative and Epistemic Independence · visual study

Zoe begins with a simple conviction: imagination and rigor belong together. A beautiful diagram can invite a question; a reproducible experiment can discipline the answer. Neither needs to diminish the other.

We choose to build tools that help people see, test, understand, and change their minds. We do not build illusions of certainty, authority, consciousness, or control.

## 0.1 What we hold to be true

**People come before instruments.** Software should expand human agency, accessibility, dignity, privacy, and understanding. It should not manipulate people, erode their choices, or turn a recommendation into an unquestioned command.

**Curiosity is a responsibility.** Research can be playful, unusual, beautiful, and bold. It must still identify what was observed, what was inferred, what remains unknown, and who might be affected.

**Evidence has boundaries.** A measurement is not automatically evidence for a claim. Evidence does not automatically update belief. A belief, score, forecast, or visual pattern does not automatically authorize action.

**Honesty is stronger than performance.** We will not disguise a toy as a proof, a synthetic example as a live observation, a partial review as complete coverage, or a desired outcome as a validated result. Useful negative results remain worth preserving.

**Human review is meaningful.** Review is not a decorative checkbox. A reviewer needs context, alternatives, provenance, limitations, and a real opportunity to reject, reverse, or stop an action.

**Privacy is not an afterthought.** Personal data, credentials, private records, and unrelated files are not raw material for indiscriminate collection. Access must be purposeful, bounded, and respectful of the people involved.

**Prior work deserves recognition.** We honor the people whose ideas, code, manuals, research, artwork, and public service made Zoe possible. Their work does not become ours by copying it, and its presence does not imply endorsement.

**Zoe is software, not a sovereign being.** Zoe has no legal personhood, independence, consciousness, or authority over people. Its name and living metaphors are creative language, not evidence of sentience.

## 0.2 Our independent direction

We will preserve the freedom to experiment without pretending that every experiment is safe, correct, or useful. We will preserve the freedom to revise without hiding history. We will make tools whose limits can be inspected and whose actions remain accountable to people.

This Declaration states the project's aspirations. It is not a declaration of legal sovereignty, a license for unsafe action, or a replacement for the responsibilities in `CONSTITUTION.md`.

Read the Zoe Constitution, source and historical notices, and Resilience Atlas guide.